

Customer Experience Review & Growth Strategy

MarryBrown Swanston St

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The Reality

A polarized **2.7★ rating** driven largely by easily fixable operational **friction points**, not fundamental product flaws.



The Fix

Zero-cost, process-driven interventions implemented at the shift level to immediately eliminate the most common complaints.



The Opportunity

An **untapped, high-yield** demographic—Muslim international students—currently defaulting to competitors due to an awareness gap.

A Polarized Customer Experience

The data reveals an inconsistent operation. When we get it right, we earn 5 stars (Advocates). When we miss, we fail completely (Detractors). The middle ground is exceptionally small.



Overall Rating | 125 Total Reviews

27%

Rate it 5 stars
(Advocates)

43%

Growth Opportunity
(1-star visits)



Voice of the Customer: Topic Synthesis

Where We Win

- ✓ Friendly staff (18 mentions)
- ✓ Spicy Food (8 mentions)
- ✓ Fried Chicken (7 mentions)
- ✓ Nasi Lemak (5 mentions)
- ✓ Welcoming atmosphere (5 mentions)

Where We Lose Trust

- ⚠ Missing items (6 mentions)
- ⚠ Cold food (4 mentions)

“Friendly, welcoming service comes up a lot in the positive reviews... it’s clearly there, just not every time.”

Diagnosing the 1-Star Visits:

3 Core Friction Points

Core Issue	Customer Evidence	Business Impact
1. Freshness	<i>"Mashed potatoes... spoiled, with a rotten smell." (BB Kd)</i> <i>"Fries were cold and not fresh at all." (Ji**y L*w)</i>	Immediate loss of repeat business.
2. Order Accuracy	<i>"Portion was tiny — nothing close to 'large.'"</i> (Ji**y L*w) <i>"Came without the curry sauce." (Y**uan *ng)</i>	High frustration, easily avoidable negative reviews.
3. Service	<i>"Asked them to cut the burger in half and the staff member was so rude." (Ai**n *ash*d)</i>	Undermines the 18 positive reviews praising friendly staff.

Operational Quick-Wins: The Fix

Friction Point	Zero-Cost Intervention	Expected Impact
Freshness & Consistency	A simple hot-holding temperature log for sides/gravy, plus a quick taste-check on batter seasoning at shift start, catches most of this before it reaches a customer.	Catches spoiled/cold food before handoff.
Order Accuracy	A 5-second visual check against the receipt before handoff, and standardized scoop sizes across shifts, would resolve the majority of these complaints at near-zero cost.	Resolves majority of portion/missing item complaints at near-zero cost.
Service Consistency	Since friendly service already shows up often... quick shift-start reminders and clear guidance on handling simple customer requests would go a long way.	Turns first-timers into regulars by standardizing the friendly service baseline.



The Blind Spot: Muslim Newcomers in Melbourne

After nearly six months living in Melbourne, I stumbled across the Swanston St store while passing through — I had no idea it was here, and no idea it was halal.

Finding reliable halal food is priority #1 for international Muslim students. Melbourne receives thousands of these students every semester. Right now, Marrybrown is invisible to them.

The Visibility Gap

	Competitors	Marrybrown Swanston St.
Digital Integration	✔ Embedded in curated Halal WhatsApp lists.	Absent from community lists.
Community Presence	✔ Visible sponsors at university iftar events and mushallahs.	Zero presence at high-trust community gatherings.
Search Optimization	✔ High visibility for 'Halal' search on Maps.	Halal certification hidden in digital footprint.

Strategic Takeaway: Competitors are winning the market purely through distribution and awareness, not better food.

Market Penetration Strategy



Let's build a 4.5★ experience.

Ready to discuss how we can implement these changes at Swanston St. from day one.

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